Extended essay: commentary for example essay			
DP subject: (Subject-focused essay)	**CHEMISTRY**		
DP subjects: (Interdisciplinary essay)		Interdisciplinary framework:	
Research question:	**How effectively can chitosan chemically remove Pb from H_2O, compared to activated carbon?**		
Assessment details			
Criterion:	Mark awarded:	Commentary: (Incorporating wording from the assessment criteria)	
A: Framework for the essay [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**4**	The research question (RQ) is relevant to the topic of investigation and it´s clearly stated. However, it could have been more specific regarding the actual materials compared: as stated it is partially focused in relation the scope of the essay. (4) Research method chosen is suitable for the RQ, but explanations related to the actual research and tables used to communicate experimental conditions are partially effective. (4) Structural conventions used in the essay support communication of the research, with some flaws. (4)	
B: Knowledge and understanding [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**5**	Relevant research materials are used to establish knowledge of the subject matter. (5) Relevant terminology is used accurately and consistently to demonstrate understanding of the subject matter. (5) Some relevant concepts are explained and used to demonstrate understanding of the subject matter. A further theoretical approach would have been more effective when explaining differences in findings. (4)	
C: Analysis and line of argument [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**4**	The essay includes analysis that is partially effective and produces some relevant findings. (4) There is a line of argument that links the RQ, findings and conclusions, but this is not always effective. (4)	
D: Discussion and evaluation	**4**	A balanced, but not always effective, discussion of the significance of the findings if often supported by appropriate evidence. (5)	

[Maximum possible mark: 8]		An evaluation of the effectiveness of the essay is present, with some strengths and limitations used. (4)
E: Reflection [Maximum possible mark: 4]	**2**	Reflection on the extended essay learning experience is partially evaluative and includes some specific examples. 2-(3) Reflections sometimes shows evidence of the student´s growth and transfer of learning. (2)
Total marks awarded	19/30	
Holistic comment on the essay:	This is a literature-based piece of work that has some insight overall but needs further clarity. The student tackled a topic that was unfamiliar and still struggled to write an argument, but produced some fair comparisons between the materials studied.	